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Chapter 5

Utilities



Introduction To Utilities

A number of utility functions are provided within Sales Analysis, which are not used during the day-to-day operation of the system, but which may be used during installation, or under certain special circumstances.

Clear Database



1/STSAU

This function clears all the user data within the Sales Analysis system. It may also be used to clear test data at installation time, prior to live running.

This function clears all data for all companies.



Warning: This utility will clear ALL data in the Sales Analysis system not just the Sales History Database.

Only continue if you are sure you want to do this.

Press ENTER to continue, or F3 to EXIT this function.

You will receive a warning screen on taking the option. Press **Enter** to continue or **F3** to exit the function.

If you choose to continue you will be prompted to press **F8** to submit the job to clear the data. Press **F8** to clear the database, or press **F3** to exit.

Reset Invoice Posted Flag

1... 2/STSAU

This function enables you to reset the invoice posted-flag on the invoice details, which indicates that they have been posted to Sales Analysis. It may be used to run the Sales History Update function again, for the same invoice data, when for example, the Sales History Database has been re-defined.

The screenshot shows a terminal window titled 'Sales Analysis Utilities' with the date '7/11/95' and time '12:17:53'. The main title is 'Reset Invoice Posted Flag'. Below it is a prompt 'Company number.?. _' followed by a blank line for input. At the bottom, there is a status bar with 'F3=Exit F4=Prompt' and a series of codes: '06-21', a small icon, 'MW', 'KS', 'IM', 'II', 'KENB20A', and 'PET178S2'.

Fields:

Company Number

You are prompted to select the company to process, or a list may be displayed by entering a ?.



Once you have selected a company, press **F8** to submit the batch job to deselect the invoices.

Reset Invoice Posted Flag Within Dates

1... 3/STSAU **2...**

This function is similar to the Reset Invoice Posted Flag function, but allows you to restrict the time period by entering a From and a To date.

The screenshot shows a terminal window titled 'Sales Analysis Utilities' with the date '7/11/95' and time '12:18:26' in the top right corner. The main title of the utility is 'Reset Invoice Posted Flag Within Dates'. Below this, there is a prompt 'Company number.?.?' followed by a cursor. Further down, there are two prompts for dates: 'Dates..... From' and 'To', each followed by a line for input. At the bottom of the screen, there is a status bar containing the text 'F3=Exit F4=Prompt' on the left and a series of codes '06-21 SF MW KS IM II KENB20A PET178S2' on the right.

Fields:

Company Number

Enter a company number.

Dates

Enter a From and To date.



Once you have entered the company, and From and To dates, press **Enter**. You will then be prompted to press **F8** to submit a batch job to deselect the selected invoices.

Flag All Invoices Posted For A Company

1... 4/STSAU **2...**

This function enables you to flag invoice details as having been posted to Sales Analysis for a particular company.

The screenshot shows a terminal window titled 'Sales Analysis Utilities' with the date '7/11/95' and time '12:19:09' in the top right corner. The main text reads 'Flag All Invoices as Posted'. Below this, there is a prompt 'Company number.?. _' followed by a cursor. At the bottom of the screen, there is a status bar with the text 'F3=Exit F4=Prompt' and a series of codes: '06-21', 'SA', 'MW', 'KS', 'IM', 'II', 'KENB20A', and 'PET178S2'.

Fields:

Company Number

Enter the company for processing, or enter a ? to obtain a list of existing companies.



Once you have entered the company, and From and To dates, press **Enter**. You will then be prompted to press **F8** to submit a batch job to deselect the selected invoices.

Zeroise Sales Analysis Values For A Period/Company



5/STSAU

This function enables you to zeroise sales history data for the Sales History Database for a specified company and period.

It may be used to reset data without having to delete the customer or simply reset unnecessary test data.

You will be prompted to enter the company and the year for which you wish to delete data..



Press **Enter** after entering the company and year. This will prompt you to press **F8** to submit the batch job to delete the data.

Delete Sales Analysis Data For A Year/Company



6/STSAU

This function enables you to delete data for the Sales History Database for a company and year. It may be used to delete old data which is no longer of interest, or simply to remove unwanted test data.

Delete Sales Analysis Data For A Year Screen

This screen enables you to delete obsolete data for specific years.

```
SA300CLP          Sales Analysis Utilities          7/11/95
                                                    12:19:45

Delete Sales Analysis Data for a Year

Company number.?.. ___
Date..... Year    ___

F3=Exit  F4=Prompt

06-21    SF      MW      KS      IM      II  KENB20A  PET178S2
```

Fields:

Company Number

Enter a company number.

Date Year

Enter a date.



You will be prompted to enter the company and the year for which you wish to delete data. Press **Enter** after typing the details; you will then be prompted to press **F8** to submit a batch job to deselect the selected invoices.

This will prompt you to press **F8** to submit the batch job to delete the data.

Change Initial Field Descriptions

1... 7/STSAU **2...**

This function may be used to change the descriptions of fields known to Sales Analysis. To be effective, this must be done prior to Sales History Database creation. The names of the fields which will be shown on displays and enquiries will then be those chosen by you. Changes made using this function will be incorporated into the database during Sales History Database creation, and will be available to database utilities.

SA09B	ST - JBA System Test Company	USER GBJBAMRX	7/11/95 12:20:30
Short Descriptions			
Field type.....	X		
Field name.....	SAYR20		
Description....	1		
Short name.....	Sales	Year	Sales Year
F3=Exit			
08-18	SA	MW	KS IM II KENB20A PET178S2

Fields:

Field Type

Enter a valid field type.

Field Name

The name for the field type.

Description

The description for the specified field type.

Short Name

The short name given to the type.

This function steps through the fields in sequence. You may overwrite the descriptions of fields, and press **Enter** to update the information and proceed on to the next field.

Change Database Field Descriptions

1... **8/STSAU**

This function is similar to the Change Initial Field Description, except that it only changes those fields chosen for incorporation in the Sales History Database, and may be used after Sales History Database Creation. However, changes made using this function will only be apparent within the Sales Analysis system, and will not be accessible to database query utilities.

Short Descriptions Screen

This screen provides a means of inputting short descriptions for existing files.

SA099	ST - JBA System Test Company	USER GJBAMRX	7/11/95 12:21:02
Short Descriptions			
Field name.....	ATC120		
From.....	CCLS20		
File.....	OEP20		
Short name.....	<u>Customer</u>	<u>Class</u>	<u>Customer Class</u>
F3=Exit			
00-10	SF	MW	KS IM II KENB20A PET178S2

Fields:

Field Name

The name of the field type.

From

The name of the From field type.

File

The name of the file.

Short Name

The short name given to the type.

This function steps through the fields in sequence. You may overwrite the descriptions of fields, and press **Enter** to update the information and proceed to the next field.

Database Creation

This option enables you to create a database relevant to your sales analysis needs.

1... **9/STSAU**
2...

Selection Of Data Elements

The Sales Analysis Define Database function is used to define a database file containing those data elements which you choose to be of importance or relevance.

You may be looking for trends such as the changes in sales volumes across regions, or the relative performance of the sales force, or you may want to analyse the sales performance of different item groups, etc.

The nature of the analysis you wish to perform, together with the information held for items and customers should serve as a guide when defining the database.

If you group your customers by region, and you wish to analyse the sales performance by region, then the 'Region' from the customer related information should be chosen for inclusion on the database. If 'Salesman' is important, then this data element should also be included. Similarly, if the 'Item Group' from the item related information is important then this should be included.

You may select up to six customer-related data elements and six item-related data elements for inclusion on the database, along with a number of value data elements.

The Sales Analysis application itself will incorporate the Customer Code and delivery sequence, the Item Code, and the value fields cost, quantity and sales value.

With Sales Analysis used within Style it is possible to load customer attributes that were applied to a particular invoice (for example, the salesman was overridden for a particular order). This means the database truly reflects your business activity. It is important to note that these details loaded off the invoice cannot be refreshed by the standard utilities.

Defining Time Period

Whilst not a part of the Create Database function, you should also consider the level of analysis you will require in terms of time period.

This is defined on the Company Profile, and may be by week or by period. Holding information at a weekly level will cause more information to be stored than if it is held by period. This value should not be changed during the normal operation of the system.



Note: There is only one Database definition for all companies in an installation of Sales Analysis. This definition may be used by all companies independently, once created.

Renaming Of Data Elements

It is possible within Sales Analysis to alter the names of data elements or fields which you see when using the system.

For example, if you use the customer related field 'Territory' to actually mean 'County' then you may change the name which will be used in Sales Analysis. This may be done in two ways and have slightly differing effects.

The function Change Initial Field Descriptions may be used to change the names of fields before database creation. If this is done, the changed names will be available in views of the database external to Sales Analysis.

The function Change Database Field Descriptions may be used after database creation, and will only change the names within Sales Analysis.

Thus, if you wish the re-name to be fully incorporated into the database, then you should set this up prior to creating the database.

A full description of the Change Initial Fields function may be found in the Utilities section of this guide.

Define Sales History Database

This procedure is used at installation time to define the contents of the Sales History data file.

You may chose up to six customer related fields, up to six item related fields, and up to five value or invoice related fields.

A batch job will be submitted, which will delete any existing Sales History Database, and create a new version according to your definition.

The screen displays a list of data elements, together with their names within Sales Analysis, grouped into Customer Related elements, Item Related elements and Invoice Related elements (values). For value items a default scaling factor will also be displayed.

You may select data elements for inclusion in the Sales History Database by entering a 1 alongside the chosen element.

To the right of each data element, you may overtype the short name which will be used within Sales Analysis. These names will be incorporated into the database definition of Sales Analysis, and will therefore be available to database query utilities.

Install Reporting Level Data



20/STSAU

When you create a sales History Database you have to specify the Reporting Level data which is used to scale the data shown on the enquiry. It may be necessary to change these at some time. This option is available to enable you to do this.



The standard Batch Processing window is displayed allowing you to confirm the request by pressing **F8**. Alternatively press **F3/F12** to return to the main Utilities options without submitting the batch job.